

Roadside cameras going dark: Another department makes changes to program over accountability concerns

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Calls for accountability, roadside cameras under scrutiny



Another police department is making changes to the roadside cameras that automatically scan license plates amid growing concerns over who has access to the data, 5 INVESTIGATES has learned.

The city of Brooklyn Park canceled its contract with the company Flock Safety at the end of December. According to city council minutes, the city signed on with Flock in the fall of 2024 to operate eight cameras around the city at a cost of \$28,000.

Inspector Matt Rabe said they cancelled the contract “due to concerns over customer support and poor data sharing protocols.”

“Accountability mechanisms must be robust,” he said in an email, adding that they still believe in the technology and are looking for a new vendor.

While Brooklyn Park did not specifically cite immigration, there continue to be questions over whether federal authorities have access to the network of cameras around the state amid a historic crackdown on immigration.

In a statement, Flock said, “Every customer that uses Flock fully owns and controls 100% of its data. Flock NEVER sells data. Agencies decide if, when, and with whom to share information, and every search in the system requires a documented reason and is logged for accountability.”

As previously reported earlier this week, the Anoka County Sheriff’s Office added new guardrails to its camera tool after 5 INVESTIGATES began asking questions about whether federal immigration authorities have access to the data.

RELATED: [More Minnesota police agencies use Flock cameras to fight crime. But who has the keys to the data?](#)

The county has since removed two federal agencies from its long list of agencies granted access to the data, and they also added a filter to be excluded from any nationwide searches involving immigration.

State Representative Sandra Feist is now pushing for clear limits and a uniform statewide policy on the use of this technology.

“More guardrails absolutely need to be in place,” she said in an interview with 5 INVESTIGATES.

“It is very clear that the data being collected through Flock, automatic license plate readers, is being used for a different purpose than the one for which it was originally intended,” she said.

A spokesperson for Flock said there is no evidence their data has been used in the immigration crackdown in Minnesota.



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